ICAR - Indian Institute of Maize Research (IIMR)
All India Coordinated Research Project (AICRP) on Maize - Disease Management
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Crop: Maize (Zea mays)
Major Diseases and Extension Advisory Recommendations

1. Turcicum Leaf Blight / Northern Corn Leaf Blight (Exserohilum turcicum / Helminthosporium turcicum):
Symptoms:
Long, elliptical, grayish-green or tan lesions (1-15 cm long) developing on lower leaves and progressing upwards. Lesions coalesce causing complete blighting of foliage.
Chemical Management (AICRP on Maize Recommendation):
- Spray Mancozeb @ 2.5 g/l of water as soon as disease symptoms appear in the field.
- Repeat spray at 10-15 day intervals depending on disease severity and weather conditions.
Tamil Nadu & South India State Recommendation (IIMR):
- Foliar spray of Mancozeb or Zineb @ 2-4 g/l of water, repeated at 10 days interval.

2. Common Rust (Puccinia sorghi):
Symptoms:
Small, powdery, cinnamon-brown pustules appearing scattered on both upper and lower leaf surfaces. Pustules rupture releasing powdery urediniospores. Pustules turn black as teliospores form late in the season.
Chemical Management (AICRP on Maize Recommendation):
- Spray Mancozeb 75% WP @ 2.0 g/l of water at the first appearance of rust pustules.
- Repeat spray at 10-14 day intervals if humid conditions persist.
- Note on Dosage Reconciliation: Extension doses are formulated in grams per litre (g/l), equivalent to 1.5 to 2.0 kg/ha in 750-1000 L water for high volume knapsack sprayers.